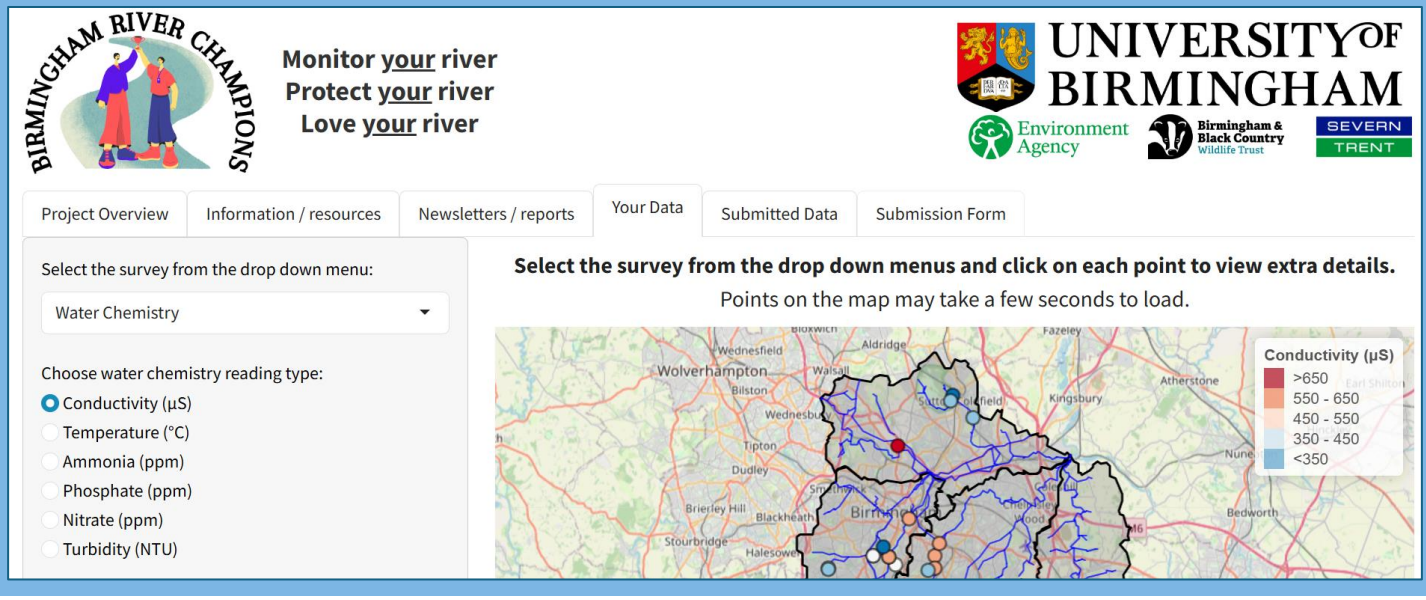
Newsletter: December 2025



Overview: Hello River Champions and season's greetings! This newsletter recaps recent activity: (1) web app updates; (2) Severn Trent resolving a pollution issue; (3) presenting at the Natural History Museum; (4) a new certification scheme; (5) a job role for Rugby River Champions goes live.

Web App Update

We have a new web app that you can access through the following link - https://birminghamriverchampions.shinyapps.io/bhamrc/. As before, here you can access resources and newsletters. But now, you can also **visualise** water chemistry trends, **download** all data and **upload** your survey results.



Seven Trent pollution update:

We've previously described pollution in the Cole at Spark Hill. Pressure from this project led to Severn Trent resolving an incorrectly plumbed multi-dwelling property that was discharging foul waste into the river. But other misconnections may still be causing pollution, and we'll continue monitoring once river levels drop in the new year.



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National Riverfly conference

Last month, Birmingham River Champions proudly presented trends Birmingham's rivers at the national Riverfly Conference at the Natural History Museum, where we showcased ecological and pollution trends based on **your** data.



New Rugby River Champions

In the last newsletter we said that Rugby Borough Council commissioning us to set up their own 'River Champions'! We've just advertised a part-time 'Project and Volunteer Engagement Officer' role, so please do share with anyone interested – please click here to see the job advert).

Celebrating Champions

We have issued our first set of certificates to volunteers, marking the launch of our new recognition scheme supported by the University's 'Birmingham Institute for Sustainability and Climate Action' (BISCA). The Bronze, Silver, Gold Awards celebrate time, skills and dedication to river monitoring and citizen science. Please email us to find out more.



Thank you & Festive Wishes

As this is our final newsletter of the year, we want to say a heartfelt thank you to everyone who has supported and contributed to Birmingham River Champions in 2025. We hope that you enjoy a restful break and we look forward to getting back out to our the rivers in the New Year!

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